

Oyster Herbals

Digital Commerce Platform

Business Requirements Document

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1 Executive Summary

1.1 Business Background

Oyster Herbals and Panchkarma Centre, located in Lal Diggi, Aligarh, Uttar Pradesh, India, is a provider of traditional Ayurvedic clinical consultations, Panchkarma therapies, and proprietary herbal remedies. For years, the clinic has operated under a physical, face-to-face model where patients undergo clinical evaluations and purchase herbal products directly from the clinic's dispensary. While this model has established a loyal customer base locally, it restricts the business's ability to serve patients remotely and showcase its full inventory to a wider regional audience.

1.2 Project Overview

The Oyster Herbals digital transformation initiative involves developing a web-based Product Catalog and Business Management Platform. This platform serves as a digital gateway, allowing users to browse products online and place orders directly via WhatsApp. It also includes secure user registration, a customer review loop, and a private administration panel for managing catalog listings.

1.3 Purpose of the Solution

The primary purpose of the platform is to digitalize the clinic's retail operations. By providing a digital product catalog and integrating WhatsApp order routing, the solution removes the need for customers to travel to the clinic or call for basic pricing and availability inquiries. It also provides a structured space for patient reviews to build brand credibility.

- Provide an accessible online showcase of herbal products.
- Simplify customer ordering through WhatsApp integration.
- Create a verified review and rating ecosystem.
- Reduce dependency on manual inquiry handling.

1.4 Expected Business Value

By launching this platform, Oyster Herbals expects to:

- Increase retail product sales by reaching customers outside the immediate Aligarh area.
- Reduce administrative workload through structured WhatsApp inquiries.
- Strengthen brand trust through verified customer testimonials.
- Enable clinic staff to update products and pricing through a self-service dashboard.

2 Business Problem Statement

2.1 Existing Challenges

The clinic's retail sales currently rely on face-to-face interactions and phone inquiries. Patients have no way to browse the product catalog, check prices, or read descriptions

online. This lack of visibility limits purchasing decisions to on-site visits and drives up phone call volume for routine inquiries.

2.2 Operational Inefficiencies

Clinic staff spend a significant portion of their day answering repetitive phone calls regarding product details, packaging sizes, and stock availability. Furthermore, staff write down shipping addresses and order details by hand during phone calls, which leads to transcription errors, incorrect shipments, and delivery delays.

2.3 Business Pain Points

- **Restricted Regional Reach:** The clinic cannot effectively market its herbal remedies outside Aligarh due to the absence of a digital product showcase.
- **No Organized Feedback System:** Patient testimonials are scattered across conversations and are not centrally maintained.
- **Manual Pricing Updates:** Product price changes are communicated verbally, creating inconsistencies and operational confusion.

2.4 Need for Digital Transformation

Consumer habits in the wellness industry increasingly favor online research and digital communication. Establishing a digital catalog integrated with WhatsApp ordering enables Oyster Herbals to modernize operations, reduce administrative overhead, and attract new customers beyond its traditional geographic market.

2.5 Business Impact Analysis

Business Area	Current Challenge	Operational Impact	Strategic Risk	Impact Rating
Product Discovery	No digital catalog; customers must call or visit.	High volume of pricing and stock inquiries.	Loss of customers to competitors with online visibility.	High
Order Processing	Manual recording of orders and addresses.	Shipping delays and address errors.	Customer dissatisfaction and increased courier costs.	High
Customer Feedback	Feedback remains verbal and undocumented.	No centralized testimonials.	Reduced customer trust and weaker brand credibility.	Medium
Catalog Updates	Pricing changes shared verbally.	Inconsistent pricing information.	Customer disputes and revenue leakage.	Medium

3 Business Objectives

3.1 Primary Objectives

- Launch an online product catalog displaying pricing, benefits, and product images.
- Route customer inquiries directly to WhatsApp using prefilled product information.
- Establish a verified customer review and rating system.

3.2 Secondary Objectives

- Provide a secure administration dashboard for catalog management.
- Implement cloud-based storage for business data and product images.

3.3 Strategic Goals

- Expand market reach across Uttar Pradesh and neighboring regions.
- Reduce administrative workload and improve staff productivity.
- Strengthen customer trust through transparent information and verified reviews.

3.4 Objectives Alignment Matrix

Strategic Goal	Business Objective	Platform Capability	Success Metric	Priority
Expand Regional Sales	Establish an online showcase of clinic products.	Public responsive product catalog.	30% increase in out-of-town orders within six months.	High
Improve Operational Focus	Route inquiries automatically to WhatsApp.	Prefilled WhatsApp order messages.	50% reduction in routine product inquiry calls.	High
Build Brand Trust	Collect verified customer reviews.	User registration and review system.	Minimum five verified reviews per core product line.	Medium
Streamline Catalog Controls	Provide a self-service administration dashboard.	Secure product management portal.	Elimination of manual price sheets.	High

4 Project Scope

4.1 In-Scope Items

lightgray Scope Element	Feature / Capability	Business Purpose
Product Catalog	Public showcase displaying product names, prices, descriptions, and images.	Allows 24/7 product discovery and pricing transparency.
WhatsApp Integration	A “Buy Now” button that routes users to WhatsApp with a prefilled message.	Simplifies ordering and prevents errors through automatic product details.
User Access Portal	Secure customer registration and login.	Verifies reviewers and protects the platform from spam reviews.
Product Reviews	Star ratings and comments on product pages.	Builds brand trust through verified customer feedback.
Admin Dashboard	A private area for staff to add, edit, and delete products.	Provides direct control over product pricing and information.
Cloud Media Pipeline	Cloud storage and optimization of product images.	Ensures fast page load times and consistent image delivery.

4.2 Out-of-Scope Items

lightgray Excluded Element	Business Rationale	Potential Future Phase
Integrated Check-out	The clinic prefers manual payment collection through UPI and bank transfers.	Online payment gateway integration.
Live Inventory Tracking	Stock is managed manually and confirmed during WhatsApp conversations.	Automated inventory management.
Shipping API Integration	Courier operations are managed manually by staff.	Third-party logistics integration.
Consultation Scheduling	Clinical appointments continue through phone and WhatsApp communication.	Online appointment booking system.

4.3 Assumptions

- Customers have access to internet-enabled devices and active WhatsApp accounts.

- Clinic staff can regularly monitor and respond to WhatsApp inquiries.
- Adequate herbal inventory is available to meet expected demand growth.

4.4 Constraints

- Cloud hosting resources must be managed efficiently to control costs.
- Order fulfillment remains dependent on manual staff availability.
- Product information must comply with healthcare and advertising regulations.

5 Stakeholder Analysis

5.1 Stakeholder Analysis Matrix

lightgray Stakeholder	Business Interest	Key Responsibility	Expectations	Influence
Dr. Anshumaan (Physician & Owner)	Brand reputation, revenue growth, clinical credibility	Clinic oversight and product approval	Professional online presence and authentic customer reviews	High
Clinic Administrative Staff	Operational efficiency and easy catalog management	Order processing and catalog maintenance	Simple dashboard and structured inquiries	High
Registered Customers	Easy access to remedies and feedback sharing	Browsing products and submitting reviews	Clear information and easy review submission	Medium
Guest Visitors	Exploring Ayurvedic products	Browsing product information	Fast performance and accurate details	Low

6 Business Requirements

6.1 Business Requirements Table

lightgray Requirement ID	Requirement Description	Business Justification	Priority
BR-001	Digital Catalog Presentation	Provide an online showcase of products and reduce routine inquiry calls.	Critical

BR-002	Frictionless WhatsApp Ordering	Simplify order initiation and reduce manual communication errors.	Critical
BR-003	Customer Profile Security	Restrict review submission to authenticated users.	High
BR-004	Verified Review Portal	Build trust through authentic customer reviews and ratings.	High
BR-005	Administrative Control Panel	Enable staff to manage product information without technical support.	High
BR-006	Cloud Data Management	Improve reliability, security, and performance of business data.	Medium

7 Functional Requirements

7.1 Functional Requirements Table

lightgray Requirement ID	Description	Associated BR	Priority
FR-001	The system must display a grid of products showing names, descriptions, prices, and images.	BR-001	Critical
FR-002	The platform must provide a “Buy Now” button that redirects users to WhatsApp.	BR-002	Critical
FR-003	The WhatsApp link must open a prefilled message containing the product name and price.	BR-002	Critical
FR-004	Users must be able to register and log in using their name, email address, and password.	BR-003	High
FR-005	User passwords must be securely encrypted before storage.	BR-003	High

FR-006	Authenticated users must be able to submit ratings and product reviews.	BR-004	High
FR-007	The platform must restrict each user to one review per product.	BR-004	High
FR-008	Users must be able to delete their own reviews and submit updated feedback.	BR-004	Medium
FR-009	Administrators must access the dashboard through a secure login page.	BR-005	Critical
FR-010	Administrators must be able to add, edit, and delete products through the dashboard.	BR-005	Critical

8 Non-Functional Requirements

8.1 Non-Functional Requirements Table

lightgray NFR ID	Category	Requirement Description	Target Metric
NFR-001	Usability	The interface must be fully responsive across desktop, tablet, and mobile devices.	100% responsive compatibility
NFR-002	Performance	The product catalog should load quickly under normal network conditions.	Below 3 seconds
NFR-003	Reliability	The platform must handle cloud or database failures gracefully.	No application crashes
NFR-004	Reliability	The system must support local image storage fallback when cloud uploads fail.	Zero failed product listings
NFR-005	Security	Administrative access must be protected through secure authentication and session management.	30-minute session timeout
NFR-006	Availability	The product catalog must remain accessible throughout the year.	99.9% uptime
NFR-007	Scalability	The database must support growth in products, customers, and reviews without performance degradation.	Sub-500ms query response

9 Risk Analysis

9.1 Risk Register

lightgray Risk ID	Description	Probability	Impact	Mitigation Strategy
RSK-001	WhatsApp link structure changes could affect order routing functionality.	Low	High	Use official click-to-chat links and provide alternative contact methods.
RSK-002	Spam or fake reviews may reduce the credibility of the platform.	Medium	Medium	Restrict review submission to registered users and monitor content regularly.
RSK-003	Cloud storage limitations could interrupt image uploads.	Medium	Medium	Optimize image sizes and maintain local storage fallback capability.
RSK-004	Database failures may result in catalog downtime or data loss.	Low	High	Implement automated backups and use reliable cloud hosting services.

10 Success Metrics

10.1 Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)

lightgray Metric	Target Goal	Measurement Method	Data Source
Website Engagement	Increase unique catalog traffic by 20% month-over-month.	Web traffic tracking and visitor analytics.	Site Analytics
Inquiry Volume	Generate 50+ WhatsApp product inquiries per month.	Monthly inquiry count.	WhatsApp Business Logs
Staff Productivity	Reduce time spent on phone-based product inquiries by 50%.	Comparison against baseline staff activity logs.	Administrative Records
Sales Conversion	Convert 15% of inquiries into completed sales.	Sales-to-inquiry ratio analysis.	Sales Records

Platform Avail- ability	Maintain consistent catalog accessibility.	Monthly uptime moni- toring.	Server Monitor- ing Tools
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11 Conclusion

11.1 Business Value

The Oyster Herbals Product Catalog and Business Management Platform provides a practical approach to digitalizing traditional Ayurvedic retail operations. By creating an accessible online catalog and integrating WhatsApp-based ordering, the platform enables the clinic to serve a broader customer base while maintaining its existing operational model.

11.2 Operational Improvements

The solution replaces time-consuming phone inquiries and manual order recording with a structured digital workflow. This improves order accuracy, reduces administrative effort, and allows clinic staff to focus more effectively on patient care and wellness services.

11.3 Growth Opportunities

The platform establishes a foundation for future business expansion by improving online visibility, strengthening customer trust through verified reviews, and supporting regional market growth. These capabilities position Oyster Herbals to scale its product business while preserving the personalized service experience that defines its brand.